from India's continued economic growth. India's impressive expansion has created an enormous need for energy. India is currently the fifth largest energy consumer in the world and is forecast to take the number 3 position, passing Russia and Japan, by 2030.[61] Experts estimate that in order to sustain its current levels of economic growth, Indian energy consumption will have to increase by approximately 4 percent per year. Oil satisfies approximately 30 percent of Indian energy needs, and more than 60 percent of India's oil is imported.[62] As economic expansion continues, India must secure an increasingly global energy lifeline. This task will require India to project power across oceans into the Middle East and Southeast Asia. And such a power projection mission will require significantly increased military capabilities, particularly in the naval sphere.[63] Thus higher defense spending and a larger, more capable Indian arsenal is inexorably linked to India's continued economic growth.

But even if increased defense capabilities are the necessary result of India's growing economy, Indian planners also believe that a more capable force will enable them to inflict severe costs on Pakistan in the event of future conflict and potentially deter the Pakistanis from further adventurism. Thus India's military buildup is to an important degree aimed at Pakistan and has resulted directly from recent Pakistani provocations. As Indian defense writer Sandeep Unnithan argues, "If Kargil and Parakram had not happened, there would be no [Indian] military modernization, since there would be no sense of urgency. Kargil and Parakram ended Indian complacency vis-à-vis Pakistan."[64]

Motivations aside, however, India's increased military spending cannot help but threaten Pakistan. Since its founding, Pakistan has been deeply insecure relative to India. At independence, Pakistan received 23 percent of British India's landmass and 18 percent of its population. The Pakistan Army was allocated six armored regiments, against India's fourteen; eight artillery regiments, against India's forty; and eight infantry regiments, against India's twenty-one. Pakistan also suffered from serious geographical challenges. For example, the country's Eastern and Western wings were separated by approximately one thousand miles of Indian territory. They also